

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer>D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.</answer>

<think>Reasoning process :

1. The patient's feelings of hopelessness, guilt, and suicidal ideations, despite being able to hold a job and get enough sleep, suggest a more severe mental health issue than a simple case of depression.
2. The patient's long-standing feelings of being "cursed" and anticipating terrible things happening to him are indicative of a pervasive pattern of anxiety and fear that is characteristic of paranoid personality disorder.
3. Double depression (A) is a type of depression that occurs in individuals with a pre-existing depressive disorder, but it doesn't fully explain the patient's pervasive sense of hopelessness and fear.
4. Mania or psychosis (B) would typically involve more significant changes in mood, energy, or thought patterns, which are not described in the scenario.
5. Anhedonia (C) is a symptom of depression, but it doesn't capture the full range of the patient's symptoms, including the pervasive fear and anxiety.
6. Paranoid personality disorder (D) is characterized by a pervasive pattern of distrust, suspiciousness, and anxiety in interpersonal relationships, which aligns with the patient's feelings of being "cursed" and anticipating terrible things happening to him.</think>